# NINA MENEZES CUNHA

## Data Scientist

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nina-menezes-cunha
https://github.com/ninamcunha
https://ninamcunha.github.io/my-portfolio/

## EXPERIENCE

### Data Scientist | Causal Inference Specialist
**Stone**
09/2025 - PRESENT  REMOTE

- Applying **causal inference, econometrics, and data science** as part of Stone's **Economic Research team** to evaluate the impact of strategic initiatives across marketing, credit, pricing, retention, product development, and banking.
- Using **SQL for large-scale data analysis** and **Python and R** for **statistical modeling and experimentation** to support evidence-based business decisions.

### Founder & CEO
**Amooora**
12/2023 - PRESENT  SÃO PAULO, BRAZIL

- Developing a **data-driven platform** fostering connection, advocacy, and information-sharing in a safe and inclusive space
- Applying **machine learning and predictive analytics** to personalize content, improve retention, and drive community engagement

### Academic Mentor (Data Science Research Projects)
**Scholar Launch**
01/2024 - PRESENT  REMOTE

- Supervising and mentoring **student-led research projects** applying **statistics, machine learning, and AI** to **real-world problems**, from proposal to publication.

### Senior Research Associate
**FHI 360**
05/2018 - 08/2023  WASHINGTON, DC

- **Led evaluations** of education programs across **10+ countries** (including Brazil, Ghana, Malawi, Guatemala, and El Salvador) using **A/B testing, machine learning,** and **quasi-experimental methods**
- Designed **predictive models** and assisted in 4 **psychometric tools** (factor analysis, PCA, clustering) to assess youth soft skills, teacher well-being, and policy impact
- Managed **large-scale datasets** (50,000+ students) to generate **actionable policy insights**
- Created **interactive dashboards and visualizations** for governments and international partners

### Senior Researcher
**Stanford University**
01/2013 - 04/2018  STANFORD, CA

- Led **randomized controlled trials** with 25,000+ students, applying **causal inference, machine learning** and **A/B testing** to evaluate program effectiveness
- Used **regression and predictive modeling** to identify interventions that improved attendance, test scores, and promotion rates
- **Published peer-reviewed research** and conducted classroom observation studies to inform policy and improve teacher effectiveness

## SUMMARY

**Data Scientist** and economist with **10+ years of experience** using **machine learning, causal inference,** and data storytelling to solve large-scale social challenges and support strategic decision-making in the private sector. From shaping **education policy** to building **predictive tools for online communities**, I turn **rigorous research** into products that drive **impact**. Now eager to apply this foundation in the **private sector**—using data to uncover patterns in user behavior, improve products, and **support smarter, evidence-based decisions**.

## EDUCATION

Bootcamp Data Science
**Le Wagon**
01/2025 - 03/2025
SÃO PAULO, BRAZIL

Ph.D. Economics of Education
**Stanford University**
09/2012 - 04/2018
STANFORD, UNITED STATES

M.A. Economics
**Universidade Federal de Minas Gerais**
01/2010 - 04/2012
BELO HORIZONTE, BRAZIL

B.A. Economics
**FGV**
01/2006 - 12/2009
SÃO PAULO, BRAZIL

## SKILLS

**Programming**
Python, SQL, R, Stata, LaTeX, MPLUS

**Data Tools**
Pandas, NumPy, Statsmodels, APIs, BeautifulSoup, Streamlit

**Machine Learning & AI**
Scikit-Learn, TensorFlow, Keras, Hugging Face, LangChain, A/B Testing

**Cloud & Deployment**
Google Cloud Platform, Docker, MLflow, Prefect

**Soft Skills**
Analytical and critical thinking, proactive problem-solving, cross-cultural collaboration, data storytelling, leadership, adaptability

**Language**
English (fluent), Portuguese (native), Spanish (advanced), French (basic)

- Co-led a seminar on Brazilian education and assisted in a flipped-classroom **statistics course, mentoring** Master's students on applied research methods

### Consultant
**Movva**
02/2015 - 12/2016 SÃO PAULO, BRAZIL

- Designed and led **large-scale education research** in 400 public schools (30,000 students), including questionnaire development, government negotiations, field supervision, and data quality assurance
- Conducted **impact evaluations** and communicated findings through **data visualizations** for policymakers and public sector stakeholders

## PUBLICATIONS AND FEATURED PROJECTS

### Amooora's Connection Algorithm
03/2025 Link

Developed a matchmaking algorithm in Python for LGBTQ+ women, utilizing machine learning and deep learning techniques (clustering with Word2Vec, topic modeling with BERTopic, embeddings with CNN) to generate inclusive, data-driven connection recommendations (link to GitHub repository).

### Are the effects of informational interventions driven by salience?
2024 Link

***American Economic Journal: Economic Policy***

*Berlinger, E., Cunha, N. M., Lischard, G., Madeira, R.*

Also published on the World Bank Development Impact Blog.

### The effects of adding social-emotional learning to a comprehensive education intervention in El Salvador on teacher well-being: a mixed methods evaluation
2024 Link

***Educational Research and Evaluation***

*Soares, F., Cunha, N.M*

### Development of a new tool for international youth programs: The YouthPower Action Youth Soft Skills Assessment (YAYSSA)
2023 Link

***European Journal of Psychological Assessment***

*Ormaco, G., Cunha, N. M., Kyllonen, P., Gates, S., Manrique, A., & Burke, H. M*

### Cross-Country Comparability of a Social-Emotional Skills Assessment Designed for Youth in Low-Resource Environments
2021 Link

***International Journal of Testing***

*Cunha N.M., Martinez A., Kyllonen P., Gates S.*

### How do we know if teachers are well? The wellbeing holistic assessment for teachers tool
2021 Link

***Journal on Education in Emergencies***

*Soares, F., Cunha, N. M., Prissll, P.*

### Through the looking glass: can classroom observation and coaching improve teacher performance in Brazil?
2018 Link

***Economics of Education Review***

*Bruns, B., Costa, L., Cunha, N. M*

## CERTIFICATIONS

**From Figma MCP to Cursor AI**
**AI Creative Builders**
01/2026

**Google Advanced Data Analytics Professional Certificate**
**Google**
12/2024
Credential ID: 98C47QKOL H8A
Via Coursera | Certificate Link

**Applied Machine Learning in Python**
**University of Michigan**
10/2023
Credential ID: D8NC5S5AKSZ Q
Via Coursera | Certificate Link

**Introduction to Computer Science with Python Part II**
**USP - University of São Paulo**
10/2023
Credential ID: T6DRTCPBAMD D
Via Coursera | Certificate Link

**Applied Plotting, Charting & Data Representation in Python**
**University of Michigan**
09/2023
Credential ID: D8NC5S5AKSZ Q
Via Coursera | Certificate Link

**Introduction to Data Science in Python**
**University of Michigan**
09/2023
Credential ID: 8TMUB39YBTD TR
Via Coursera | Certificate Link

**Introduction to Computer Science with Python Part I**
**USP - University of São Paulo**
09/2023
Credential ID: VGR22WM5K5G J
Via Coursera | Certificate Link

**Categorical Structural Equation Modeling**
**Statistical Horizons**
05/2021
Certificate Link

**Applied Measurement Modeling**
**CenterStat**
05/2021
Certificate Link

**Introduction to Structural Equation Modeling**
**CenterStat**
05/2021
Certificate Link